

Company strategy and context

Entirely fictional. Case snapshot: August 31, 2026. Synthetic organizational evidence for a hackathon prototype.

Business and customers

Asteron Systems is a fictional European B2B software company with approximately 2,000 employees and 650 enterprise customers in Europe and North America. Annual recurring revenue at the snapshot is EUR 117 million. Subscription fees depend on modules, users and transaction bands. Standard support is included; premium support and implementation services are sold separately. ARR is a point-in-time subscription run rate, not recognized annual revenue.

Products and growth

Asteron Flow manages operational workflows. Asteron Service manages service interactions. Asteron Data connects and synchronizes operational records. Customers combine these products with their own applications. Two acquired product families were brought into the portfolio over the past three years. Expansion has added customers, interfaces, regional teams and different release schedules.

Customer economics

Core Enterprise accounts have less extensive deployments. Strategic Enterprise accounts have more integrations and negotiated service commitments. Both are enterprise customers. The opening customer base was 600 on September 1, 2025. Over the following 12 months, 72 opening-cohort customers left and 122 new customers joined; none of these new customers left within this window. The closing base is 650. Annual opening-cohort logo retention is $528 / 600 = 88\%$. Revenue retention is not provided.

Strategic question

Where in our customer-service system should we intervene if we want to improve customer retention, customer experience, and profitable sustainable growth?

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Priorities for the next 12 months

1. Increase annual opening-cohort customer retention from 88% to 93%.
2. Improve customer experience and service consistency.
3. Protect margins while scaling.
4. Free employee capacity for more proactive and higher-value customer interaction.
5. Maintain consistent service quality during international growth.
6. Accelerate AI adoption only where it creates meaningful value.

Leadership position

The executive team has explicitly said: do not start with "what can we automate with AI?" A small improvement in a high-volume task is useful, but leadership wants the proposed intervention connected to customer outcomes and to a credible operating change. Released capacity needs a named use and owner.

Operating model

Customer Support and Technical Support together employ 180 people: 100 frontline agents, 60 technical specialists, 10 team leads, 4 quality analysts, 3 knowledge managers and 3 workforce/operations analysts. For KPI allocation, 160 direct delivery FTE are distributed as 50 simple, 50 medium and 60 complex FTE equivalents. These are capacity allocations, not rigid staffing silos. The other 20 roles are included in the support cost pool. Customer Success, Product Engineering, Security and Finance sit outside this group.

Service commitments

The service handles approximately 18,000 requests a month. Routine requests are usually resolved effectively. Complex requests have more contacts and longer elapsed resolution. Premium critical incidents receive 24/7 response; ordinary queues follow regional business hours. Contractual response targets differ by tier. No universal resolution SLA is assumed.

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Systems and interfaces

The fictional stack includes CaseHarbor for ticketing, AccountVista for CRM and renewal records, DocNest for support articles, TeamLine for internal collaboration, BuildTrack for engineering defects, and MetricDock for service reporting. The acquired Data team also uses a product-specific operations space. Identity is federated, but access remains role- and customer-specific. CaseHarbor has nightly exports; its sandbox API supports read access and limited reversible tagging. There is no production-write connection in the hackathon.

Current initiatives

A 12-agent ticket-summary pilot ran in July. Classification has been tested offline. A customer chatbot has a vendor proposal but no deployment approval. Other ideas are listed in the opportunity backlog. The ideas have different sponsors and use unverified benefit assumptions.

Leadership concerns

Expansion is increasing cross-product work. The May release generated a measurable defect wave. A North America staffing gap in July and August reduced overlap with European specialists. Some customers take several days to provide diagnostic access. Team leads disagree about whether routing, capacity, release quality or enablement deserves priority. Ticket throughput appears in team scorecards alongside customer satisfaction.

Business constraints

The initial operating pilot must fit EUR 60,000 of incremental spend and eight weeks. No headcount reduction is planned. Existing contracts cannot be changed for the pilot. Product fixes remain on a separate engineering budget. Customer Success can accept up to 80 hours per month of reassigned support capacity for proactive account reviews, subject to scheduling and customer consent. The head of Support owns that allocation; unused hours must be reported.

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How to read the evidence extracts

The monthly KPI export contains 12 months with simple, medium, complex and all rows. All is the sum of the three segments for counts and costs; do not add it again. The 50 closed tickets are a purposive case sample and do not reconstruct the KPI population. Customer comments refer to selected tickets and are not independent observations. The 20 employee comments include both general and case-specific views.

Measurement definitions

Simple cases follow a standard path; medium cases involve mainly single-product configuration or coordination; complex cases involve cross-product investigation, uncertainty or technical risk. Complexity is assigned after closure and differs from urgency. New arrivals and final closures are monthly flows. Opening backlog + arrivals - closures = closing backlog. FCR, repeat contact and escalation use final closures as the denominator. First-contact resolution requires one interaction cycle with no repeat within seven days; repeat contact means renewed customer contact within seven days after apparent resolution.

Rates, time and costs

All percentage fields use a 0-100 scale. CSAT is ratings 4 or 5 divided by survey responses, not by all cases. Aggregate numerator and denominator rather than averaging percentages. Resolution hours include weekends and customer waits and are not labor hours. Cost per closed case is the allocated support cost pool divided by closures, including support overhead but excluding separately budgeted engineering fixes. Productivity is closed cases / allocated delivery FTE. Defect-linked cases have an engineering link; this does not attribute all elapsed time to the defect.

Time and join conventions

The business snapshot is August 31, 2026; seven-day closure outcomes are frozen September 8. Ticket date is opening date; customer feedback date identifies its focal case. Employee dates identify the comment date. Ticket IDs are sample identifiers, not a chronological sequence. Article IDs link to current snapshot text; historical article versions are not supplied. Blank survey and annual retention fields are missing, not zero. Annual logo retention is only available for the complete September-August opening cohort. Monthly account churn uses opening monthly accounts. No account-level churn labels or active labor logs are provided.